

The 6:15

SATURDAY · OCTOBER 3, 2026

NO. 23

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · WEEKEND FORMAT, COLLAPSED

This week	Sun 10/4 OPEC+ 68th JMMC review — no quota change expected, seven members already held Oct. output flat. Tue 10/14, 8:30a ET Sept. CPI; Wed 10/15, 8:30a ET Sept. PPI.
Standing	FOMC next meets Oct. 27-28. Funding runs on the Dec. 11 CR, no shutdown risk. No frontier-AI release or rocket launch verified in the last 48h (OpenAI's \$122B round is April news, not re-reported).

Weekend format: calendar collapsed to two lines per masthead convention.

METRICS · FRI 10/2 CLOSE/SETTLE, ET UNLESS NOTED

Oil / rates / FX	Brent \$102.25 (-0.06%) / WTI \$91.11 (-1.90%), spread ~\$11.14, ICE/NYMEX settle. 2Y 4.46% / 10Y 5.28% / 30Y 5.63% (Treasury.gov CMT). DXY 101.92 (-0.01%).
Equities / other	S&P futures (Dec) 7,777.25 (+0.69%); Nasdaq futures (Dec) 31,061.75 (+0.98%); VIX 15.31 (-6.59%); gold \$4,162.30 (-0.95%). Asia/Europe Fri closes: Nikkei 68,309.46 (-0.94%), Hang Seng 23,972.29 (-2.60%), FTSE 10,461.95 (+0.32%), DAX 25,231.20 (+1.17%), CAC 7,897.19 (+0.79%). AAA gas \$4.3807/gal, today 10/3.

All levels confirmed via Treasury.gov and exchange/quote-page data this run; none estimated.

HORMUZ COUNTERS · STRAITS.LIVE, ~08:50 UTC TODAY UNLESS NOTED

Transits	1 on Sept. 27 vs. 85/day baseline (IMF PortWatch, lagged); separately, Kpler's 10-day average ~10 vessels/day, lowest since May.
Vessels holding	90 AIS-visible (08:50 UTC today), down from 148 (Oct. 2) and 135 (Sept. 30) — third straight daily drop, not yet called a trend.
War-risk / dark tankers	Hull war-risk 3%-10% of vessel value per trade-press reporting this week (straits.live's own premia feed

degraded, 3rd issue running); no Hormuz-specific dark-tanker count located this run.

Crisis / escalation

Crisis Pressure: extreme, flat. Escalation Forecast: flipped to elevated, rising (was easing Thu.) — driven by the Brent-WTI forward spread, not new strike data.

Methodology: PortWatch transit counts (lagged, official) and Kpler's rolling average (smoothed) measure different windows and are never averaged here; AIS vessel-holding counts and war-risk premia are separate instruments again (same-day volatility vs. periodic insurance-market reporting).

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees

Swept Red Sox 2-0 in Wild Card (9-0, 9-2); open ALDS today at Tampa Bay (Tropicana Field, TBS/truTV/HBO Max). **Corrects issue No. 22, which wrongly reported a 1-1 split and a decisive Game 3 — see colophon.**

Knicks

No reported moves in the last 24 hours; preseason opens Mon. 10/5 at Philadelphia.

Northwestern

No reported moves in the last 24 hours.

LEAD

FED ODDS / HORMUZ

Fed hike odds, already cut to the mid-30s on Wednesday's soft PCE, crater again to roughly 17%-18% after a weak jobs report — but oil holds near \$100 on a worsening Hormuz read

Friday's Employment Situation report (BLS, 8:30a ET) showed nonfarm payrolls up just 29,000 in September against a trailing 12-month average gain of 45,000 a month, with the unemployment rate "changed little" at 4.2% and 7.1 million people unemployed. That is a much softer print than the labor-market resilience the Fed had been citing as grounds to keep hiking into the Oct. 27-28 meeting.

The market reaction compounded Wednesday's PCE-driven repricing rather than reversing it. Kalshi and Polymarket, which had priced

roughly 65%-66% odds of an October hike as recently as Sept. 27, cut that to the mid-30s by Thursday morning on the PCE miss (this brief's Thursday lead), then slashed it again Thursday into Friday to roughly 17%-18% after payrolls — both platforms converging on a hold priced at ~82%-84% and a cut at only ~2%. That is three successive down-legs in hike odds inside a single week on two separate data points, one of the fastest repricings in this series since the Sept. 16 hike itself.

Oil did not confirm the dovish turn. Brent settled Friday at \$102.25, WTI at \$91.11 — both little-changed to lower on the session (-0.06%/-1.90%) but still elevated versus pre-crisis levels, with the spread near \$11, wide even by this year's standards. The mechanical disconnect flagged in Thursday's lead persists: a genuinely dovish growth/inflation signal should pull the dollar and long-end yields down with oil; instead DXY held flat at 101.92 and the 10-year firmed intraday Friday to 5.28%, the 30-year to 5.63%, both near cycle highs. The VIX tells yet another story — a sharp -6.59% crush to 15.31, suggesting equity-vol sellers either aren't pricing the Hormuz risk the oil market is pricing, or are reading the jobs-driven hold as the dominant signal for risk assets specifically.

The Hormuz side of the ledger got more serious overnight, not less, even as the AIS-visible stranded-vessel count kept falling (148 → 90 Thursday-to-Saturday). UKMTO logged a fourth distinct tanker-strike incident in six days — one more vessel hit by an unidentified projectile Thursday, on top of Tuesday night's three-tanker barrage. A report citing an unnamed Tehran source said Iran is "preparing for a major round of fighting" with the US (**single-sourced**); Foreign Minister Araghchi separately said on record his country would fight even an "apocalyptic" war rather than concede its sequencing terms.

Washington has now committed a fifth carrier strike group — USS Theodore Roosevelt, underway since Sept. 27, relieving USS George Washington — to a conflict now in its eighth month.

Stakes: a Fed with two consecutive soft data points pointing toward a hold, against an oil market and a straits.live escalation model (now elevated, rising) both pricing the opposite risk. The Oct. 14 CPI and Oct. 15 PPI prints will matter more than usual precisely because payrolls and PCE already did most of the work on the growth/inflation side — the open variable into the FOMC is now Hormuz, not domestic data. Sunday's OPEC+ JMMC review is a secondary input; no quota change is expected.

BUSINESS

Nike's FQ1 2027 results, filed with the SEC after Thursday's close, showed diluted EPS of \$0.72 against the \$0.44 consensus this brief tracked Tuesday, and revenue of \$10.97B against an \$11.33B consensus — a top-line miss masked by a bottom-line beat. The EPS outperformance traces to a \$986M one-time benefit tied to an expected recovery of IEEPA tariff payments, not the underlying business; CEO Elliott Hill cited the "Sport Offense" initiative and a new "Pace" platform. Strip out the one-time item and the print reads closer to in-line-to-soft on revenue, with the Vietnam/China tariff-sourcing exposure flagged in issue No. 22 still unresolved.

GEOPOLITICS

No confirmed follow-on large-scale Russian strike on Ukraine located this run since the drone/missile barrage reported in issue No. 22 **(not re-verified)**. No new Houthi-Saudi exchange since Sept. 26; the Makkah Joint Defense Agreement stands.

IRAN & HORMUZ

The diplomatic track stalled rather than advanced. Trump publicly rejected Iran's seven-day Hormuz-reopening proposal as "unacceptable," saying Tehran floated it because "they are dying — the money isn't coming in," and that the US has "established the greatest blockade in military history." US officials separately indicated fresh airstrikes are more likely after the Nov. 3 midterms than before. Iran's own framing, per Reuters sourcing cited in regional coverage, is that both sides "largely agree on the steps" but remain divided on sequencing — sanctions relief and frozen-asset access before or after denuclearization steps — the same fault line flagged in issue No. 22. A separate, unconfirmed claim that Iran has offered to dilute and transfer its 60%-enriched uranium stockpile to a third party under IAEA-recognized mechanisms could not be corroborated beyond the single report that carried it this run.

Physically: a fourth tanker-strike incident (Thursday, unidentified projectile, fire reported, crew safe, damage unknown per UKMTO) follows Tuesday's three-tanker barrage and the Sept. 28-29 cluster (Al Funtas, Mersin Prosperity, Sinbad, and a fourth vessel) — the busiest ten days of strikes since the war began in late February. Against that, the AIS-visible vessel-holding count keeps falling (244 → 148 → 90 over four days) and transit data remains too lagged to resolve whether that fall reflects de-escalation or degraded tracking; straits.live's own Escalation Forecast moved the other way, to elevated/rising, on the widening Brent-WTI spread rather than new strike data (**model-driven, weights not disclosed**). War-risk premia are carried at the 3%-10% hull-value range reported by the trade

press this week; straits.live's own premia feed remains degraded for a third consecutive issue.

SPORTS

Yankees	Swept Red Sox 2-0 in Wild Card (9-0, 9-2); open ALDS today at Tampa Bay (Tropicana Field).
Knicks	No game; preseason opens Mon. 10/5 at Philadelphia.
Northwestern	Beat Penn State 34-13 in the Ryan Field opener Fri. 10/2; now 3-1.

Continuity. Corrected this issue: issue No. 22 wrongly reported the Yankees-Red Sox series "tied 1-1" entering a "decisive Game 3" — confirmed via MLB.com and Baseball-Reference box scores that this was a 2-0 sweep, 18-2 aggregate, with no Game 3 played. Cut as unmoved: Politics (nothing new located), Technology (no frontier-AI release or launch verified in 48h), Economics (ISM's consensus and a clean read could not be verified this run, not re-reported as a guess). Not refreshed this run: Hormuz dark-tanker count (no same-day Hormuz-specific source), straits.live's war-risk premia feed (degraded, third issue running), confirmation of further Russia strikes on Ukraine. Watch for next issue: today's ALDS Game 1 result; Sunday's OPEC+ JMMC outcome; whether the 244 → 148 → 90 Hormuz vessel-count slide holds through a full week or reverses; Oct. 14 CPI as the next data point the Fed-odds market trades on; any Iranian response to the US counter-proposal.

Unverified figures are marked in red: the Hormuz dark-tanker count, war-risk premia (carried range, feed degraded), the "major round of fighting" characterization (single anonymous source), the 60%-enrichment-transfer proposal (single-sourced), and UKMTO's Thursday damage assessment (UKMTO itself calls it unknown). Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.